CHEAT SHEET

Core glossary

Term	In one breath
SIP	Session Initiation Protocol. Application signaling that creates, modifies, and ends sessions.
SDP	Session Description Protocol. The text format that describes media streams for offer/answer.
Offer/answer	The rule set that pairs one SDP offer with one SDP answer. The answer mirrors the offer's m-line count and order.
RTP	Real-time Transport Protocol. Carries media samples. It is not SIP.
SRTP	Secure RTP. Encrypts and authenticates media packets.
Dialog	A peer relationship identified by Call-ID, local tag, and remote tag.
Transaction	One request and its responses, identified on a hop by the Via branch.
B2BUA	Back-to-back user agent. A UAS on one side glued to a UAC on the other. Taxonomy: RFC 7092.
ICE	Interactive Connectivity Establishment. Tries candidate pairs until one works.
STUN	Session Traversal Utilities for NAT. Binding checks and mapped addresses.
TURN	Traversal Using Relays around NAT. Allocates a relayed media address.
PRACK	Provisional acknowledgement. Makes selected 1xx responses reliable when 100rel is in use.
REFER	Asks another UA to issue a request, typically for transfer.
telephone-event	RTP payload for DTMF and related tones.
SIPREC	SIP recording protocol. A session is forked to a recording server.
PAI	P-Asserted-Identity. An identity asserted inside a trusted network, not a cryptographic proof.
E911	Emergency calling from multi-line systems. Location and routing rules are in RFC 6881 and FCC MLTS rules.
Direct Routing	Microsoft Teams Phone connectivity through a certified customer SBC.

Sources and go deeper

- RFC 3261 — last checked 2026-10
- RFC 8866 — last checked 2026-10
- RFC 3264 — last checked 2026-10
- RFC 3550 — last checked 2026-10
- RFC 3711 — last checked 2026-10
- RFC 3261 §12 — last checked 2026-10
- RFC 3261 §17 — last checked 2026-10
- RFC 7092 — last checked 2026-10
- RFC 8445 — last checked 2026-10
- RFC 8489 — last checked 2026-10
- RFC 8656 — last checked 2026-10
- RFC 3262 — last checked 2026-10
- RFC 3515 — last checked 2026-10
- RFC 4733 — last checked 2026-10
- RFC 7866 — last checked 2026-10

- RFC 3325 — last checked 2026-10
- RFC 6881 — last checked 2026-10
- Plan Direct Routing — last checked 2026-10

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